

Intensive Protocol Archive

A forum and funding initiative for social and psycho-technologies of alternative experience.

Sous le monde réel, il existe un monde idéal, qui se montre resplendissant à l'œil de ceux que des méditations graves ont accoutumés à voir dans les choses plus que les choses. -Victor Hugo

IPA rests on the key insight that the institutions and systems of the West are largely built upon an *extensive* account of reality: they see in the material world atomic properties of quantity, metric stability, derived out to the discrete borders of territory, ownership and personhood we call property and civil subjecthood. On the sidelines, in little disciplined pockets of life we call art or spirituality, an alternative account of reality is maintained. Philosophers like Bergson and Deleuze refer to *intensive* properties of reality: processual structures (or fields) of affect, potential, emergence and becoming. They register to us as atmospheres, vibes, transpersonal ordeal, and a sense of the unqualified power or potential of a material ensemble.

Intensive Experience

Intensive structures and lens of experience nonetheless animate many of our institutions: the sigil magick of branding, the affect-heavy atmospherics of patriotism, Nike's attempted monopoly on athletic becoming and flow, all facilely bent to the end of capture and control. This same regime of capture (which regards intensive structures as means to measure rather than ends) will regard attempts at autonomous experimentation with them with marginalization or ridicule (picture the corporate slurs thrown at [Julia Butterfly Hill](#) by Pacific Lumber Company executives as she tried to assert the material singularity of Luna, the 1,000 year old California redwood). This culture of derision as a political tactic goes back to the Catholic church's marginalization of women mystics in the 14th century (catalogued in great detail [here](#)), when direct democratization of what theologians call *esoteric* access to the mysteries threatened an upheaval in the church's concentration of power, and "exoteric" Christianity became (and has remained) the disciplinary rule of the day.

We, of course, are materialists, and we see in the esoteric and activist movements of the past not secret access to a transcendent realm, but alternative vantage on these real structures in the here and now, generative structures of process and becoming that can be handled, engaged, designed for, and which can be sources of empowerment and social cohesion. The power of cultural undergrounds comes from nothing more than the willingness to ignore the categorical, *extensive* myopia of the institutions and assert the intensive realm as a fully fleshed and adequate dimension of the real, one that it is possible to organize life around. If power seeks to discipline these forbidden dimensions behind the walls of art and spirituality in order to control, defang and mystify them, then our task (as praetors of [the protocol underground](#)) is to break them out of the [anchorhold](#) and bring them out into the light of day.

At this moment, as the legitimacy of the dominant institutions crumbles before our eyes, the underground is ascendant: we are witnessing political and economic networks distribute and protocolize monies, memetic production and organizational capacity. Awakening to the socio-genetic potential of these tools is

as close as this shattering of integrity by the kleptocratic forces in charge is obvious. But keeping these tools as our sole means puts us in danger of missing the mystical power the old structures have maintained by holding a mysterion monopoly on this world of process and becoming we call the intensive. In the era of neo-fascism, with its post-liberal return to the cynical mysticism of blood and soil, we must take up the cause of the medieval heretics, the acidheads of Orange County, the Buddhists of Nalanda Mahavihara, the nightclub queers of 80's Greenwich Village and the alchemical DJs of the 70's Bronx. We must build a machine to democratize, distribute and protocolize technologies of intensive experience.

IPA

The Intensive Protocol Archive (IPA) is an erowid-style repository for intensive protocols - that is, protocols where a qualitative engagement with reality in its emergent becoming is the intended outcome. These protocols are not art practices (which tend toward a representational outcome), scientific experiments (which likewise produce an external output), medical or treatment oriented applications (which tend toward a social functionalism opposite the exploratory and extitutional aspirations of CID) , or mystical or religious exercises (which allude to or seek to construct a *supernatural* system against the materialist-naturalist framework of intensive philosophy); these are rather practical technologies for exploring sensory relations to the physical world grounded in alternative ontological grammars.

In the spirit of Erowid, the archive will allow users to:

- document, specify, combine and fork intensive protocols
- contribute "Experiences" or phenomenological attestations to flesh out the use and character of intensive protocols (through the use of free narrative or the [Subjective Effect Index](#) and [other taxonomies](#) of non-normal experience)
- develop research communities and funding bodies to support intensive [extitutions](#)

In the age of AI, neurophenomenological frameworks like [Qualia Computing](#), and the coming revolutions in brain computer interface (BCI), biocomputation and advanced granular sensor deployment, the reach and capacity of practical technologies of the intensive are limitless. To begin the conversation, we intend to exploit the many decades (indeed centuries) of protocols and techniques developed in the factory of intensive production that is the underground. Whether it's the standard four piece American rock band, traditional rope bondage of BDSM, the [psychogeography](#) of the Situationists, the transpersonal escapades of the [Deep Play Institute](#) or the expansive psychotechnologies of the Buddhist tradition, the archive holds a wide variety of protocols and experiencer attestations pointing to lines of flight that can break the spell of the current moment.

Decentralized Tech for Intensive Experience

The provocation of the underground to DeSci is to let the inherent empirical capacity of scenes bleed into both the sciences and [alternative empiricisms](#). This would include the humanities but gestures toward a third pole, an esoteric/intensive empiricism that can't be contained within the umwelt regimes of the State

or the private sector . While DeSci is already forging a path, these alternatives provide a full-bodied zeitgeist for decentralized funding to the extent that centralization, ideology and bureaucracy are anathema to strategies of intensive experience.

An Intensive Protocol Archive must therefore look to all available p2p funding strategies to operationalize research. This could mean election of terminal, project oriented DAOs for the strategic development of intensive protocols, or, perhaps better, Terra0 style autonomous wallets, enabled by agents after a careful process, that represent the interests of intensive protocols without the help of stewards. On the resource side, creative, community-sourced rubrics could be combined with the sorting powers of LLMs to generate diverse and changing funding criteria that avert [Goodhart's Law](#) while providing a method of multidimensional discovery and support adequate to the dynamism of the subject matter (experience attestations could be queried for sense of wellbeing on one day and depersonalization on another).

The ideal output of an IPA would be the production of more [open protocols](#), that is, protocols that merge technical specifications with an open-ended, empirical cultural ethos into a memetically tight, reproducible formula that can leave the reservation of the too-much-online community to take on a life of its own in the underground. Despite whatever institutional dressings it may have to inhabit in order to accomplish this, the ultimate direction and metric of success for IPA is as *a real site of extitutional production*, in service to the spontaneous and informal exploration of those who chart their own course outside of the castle walls of dominant institutions.

The Intensive Protocol Archive is one proposed facet of a larger initiative by The Open Machine to amplify and center the genius of underground publics.